BAPTIST FAITH & MESSAGE - 2000

CHAPTER XII - EDUCATION

1

BAPTIST FAITH AND MESSAGE COMPARISON

1925

Christianity is the religion of enlightenment and intelligence. In Jesus Christ are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. All sound learning is therefore a part of our Christian heritage. The new birth opens all human faculties and creates a thirst for knowledge. An adequate system of schools is necessary to a complete spiritual program for Christ's people. The cause of education in the Kingdom of Christ is coordinate with the causes of missions and general benevolence, and should receive along with these the liberal support of the churches.

1963

The cause of education in the kingdom of Christ is co-ordinate with the causes of missions and general benevolence and should receive along with these the liberal support of the churches. An adequate system of Christian schools is necessary to a complete spiritual program for Christ's people.

In Christian education there should be a proper balance between academic freedom and academic responsibility. Freedom in any orderly relationship of human life is always limited and never absolute. The freedom of a teacher in a Christian school, college, or seminary is limited by the pre-eminence of Jesus Christ, by the authoritative nature of the Scriptures, and by the distinct purpose for which the school exists.

The bylaws of BBC currently call the 1963 as our doctrinal standard.

2000

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BFM 2000 – Chapter XII

3

SOUTHERN BAPTIST

SEMINARIES, COLLEGES, & UNIVERSITIES

4

Southern Baptist Seminaries

- Gateway Seminary of the Southern Baptist Convention (Ontario, California)
- Midwestern Baptist Theological Seminary (Kansas City, Missouri)
- New Orleans Baptist Theological Seminary (New Orleans, Louisiana)
- The Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary (Wake Forest, North Carolina)
- The Southwestern Baptist Theological Seminary (Fort Worth, Texas)
- The Southern Baptist Theological Seminary (Louisville, Kentucky)
  - The first SBC seminary which was founded in 1859 by James P. Boyce

5

Southern Baptist Seminaries

- These seminaries are all funded by the Cooperative Program
- Approximately 22% of the Coop. funds goes to these six seminaries as well as the SBC Historical Library and Archives
- If you are in an SBC church and want to go to one of these seminaries, your education will be much more affordable than anywhere else

6

Southern Baptist Colleges

- There are no colleges or universities officially associated with the SBC (outside the 5 that are directly associated with the SBC seminaries
- The colleges that are SBC affiliated are affiliated only through the state convention (e.g., Alabama Baptist Association)
- The University of Mobile is the only official partner of the ABA

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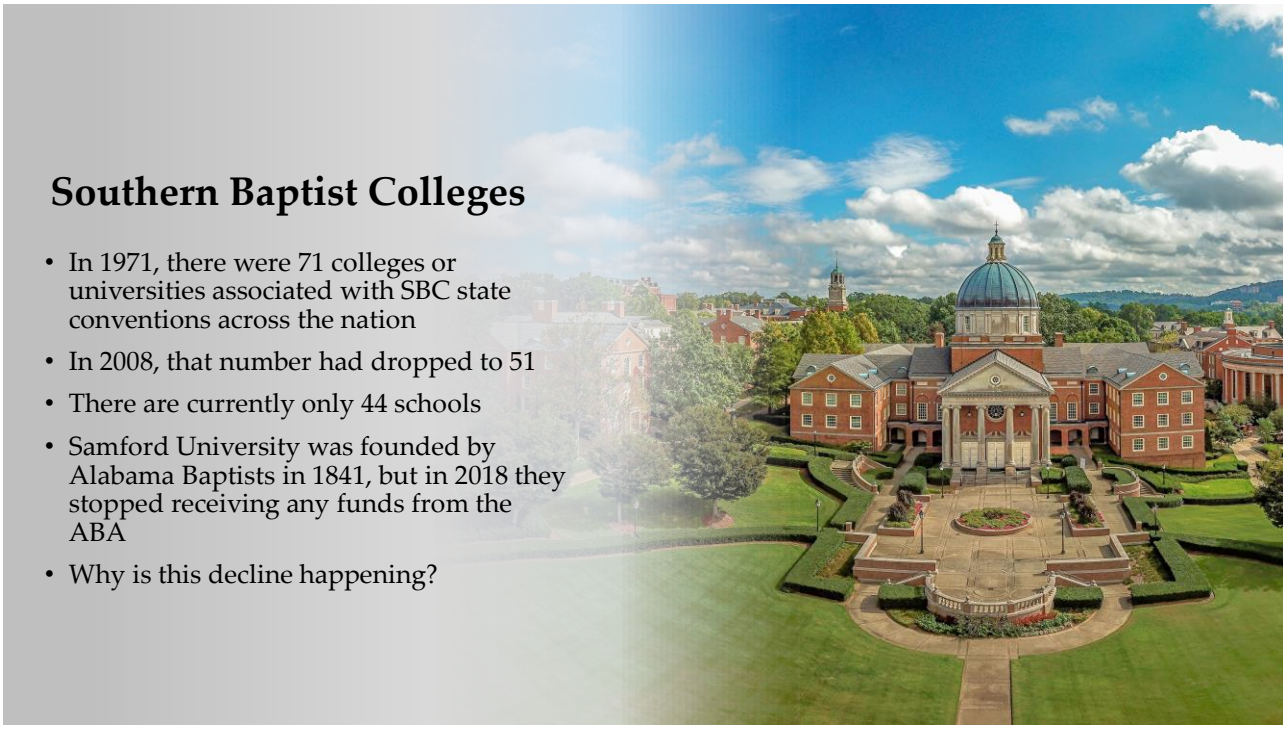

Southern Baptist Colleges

- In 1971, there were 71 colleges or universities associated with SBC state conventions across the nation
- In 2008, that number had dropped to 51
- There are currently only 44 schools
- Samford University was founded by Alabama Baptists in 1841, but in 2018 they stopped receiving any funds from the ABA
- Why is this decline happening?

8

The Source of Truth

9

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10

The Source of Truth

- God is the source of all truth, understanding, and wisdom

11

"

Psalm 111:10 (ESV)
10 The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom;
all those who practice it have a good understanding.
His praise endures forever!

"

12

“

Proverbs 3:5–6 (ESV)
5 Trust in the LORD with all your heart,
and do not lean on your own understanding.
6 In all your ways acknowledge him,
and he will make straight your paths.

”

13

“

John 14:6 (ESV)
6 Jesus said to him, “I am the way, and the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.

”

14

“

Colossians 2:1–3 (ESV)
For I want you to know how great a struggle I have for you and for those at Laodicea and for all who have not seen me face to face, 2 that their hearts may be encouraged, being knit together in love, to reach all the riches of full assurance of understanding and the knowledge of God's mystery, which is Christ, 3 in whom are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge.

”

15

The Source of Truth

- God is the source of all truth, understanding, and wisdom
- If knowledge and wisdom come from God, then they are gifts of God
- James 1:16–17 (ESV) - 16 Do not be deceived, my beloved brothers. 17 Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights, with whom there is no variation or shadow due to change.
- What kind of people reject God?

16

“

Psalm 14:1 (ESV)
[1] The fool says in his heart, “There is no God.”
They are corrupt, they do abominable deeds;
there is none who does good.

”

17

“

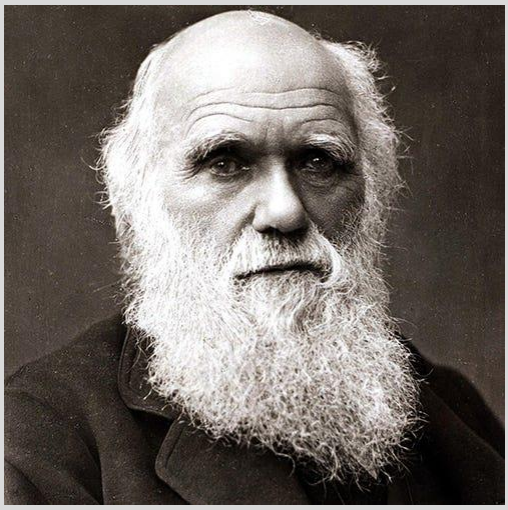
Romans 1:19–25 (ESV)
[19] For what can be known about God is plain to them, because God has shown it to them. [20] For his invisible attributes, namely, his eternal power and divine nature, have been clearly perceived, ever since the creation of the world, in the things that have been made. So they are without excuse. [21] For although they knew God, they did not honor him as God or give thanks to him, but they became futile in their thinking, and their foolish hearts were darkened.
[22] Claiming to be wise, they became fools, [23] and exchanged the glory of the immortal God for images resembling mortal man and birds and animals and creeping things.
[24] Therefore God gave them up in the lusts of their hearts to impurity, to the dishonoring of their bodies among themselves, [25] because they exchanged the truth about God for a lie and worshiped and served the creature rather than the Creator, who is blessed forever! Amen.

”

18

The Fool Says in His Heart…

- Atheism and Agnosticism are filled with intelligent people
- What is the end of all their knowledge?

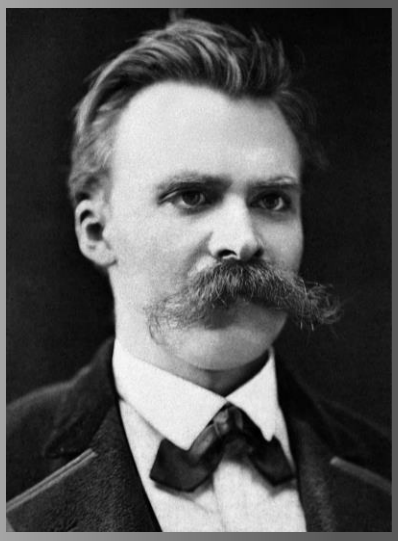


Charles Darwin

19

Haven't you heard of that madman who in the bright morning lit a lantern and ran around the marketplace crying incessantly, 'I'm looking for God! I'm looking for God!' Since many of those who did not believe in God were standing around together just then, he caused great laughter. Has he been lost, then? asked one. Did he lose his way like a child? asked another. Or is he hiding? Is he afraid of us? Has he gone to sea? Emigrated? - Thus they shouted and laughed, one interrupting the other. The madman jumped into their midst and pierced them with his eyes. 'Where is God?' he cried; 'I'll tell you! We have killed him - you and I! We are all his murderers. But how did we do this? How were we able to drink up the sea? Who gave us the sponge to wipe away the entire horizon? What were we doing when we unchained this earth from its sun? Where is it moving to now? Where are we moving to? Away from all suns? Are we not continually falling? And backwards, sidewards, forwards, in all directions? Is there still an up and a down? Aren't we straying as though through an infinite nothing? Isn't empty space breathing at us? Hasn't it got colder? Isn't night and more night coming again and again? Don't lanterns have to be lit in the morning? Do we still hear nothing of the noise of the grave-diggers who are burying God? Do we still smell nothing of the divine decomposition? - Gods, too, decompose! God is dead! God remains dead! And we have killed him!

Friedreich Nietzsche, *The Gay Science*, 1882.



20

How can we console ourselves, the murderers of all murderers! The holiest and the mightiest thing the world has ever possessed has bled to death under our knives: who will wipe this blood from us? With what water could we clean ourselves? What festivals of atonement, what holy games will we have to invent for ourselves? Is the magnitude of this deed not too great for us? Do we not ourselves have to become gods merely to appear worthy of it? There was never a greater deed - and whoever is born after us will on account of this deed belong to a higher history than all history up to now!' Here the madman fell silent and looked again at his listeners; they too were silent and looked at him disconcertedly. Finally he threw his lantern on the ground so that it broke into pieces and went out. 'I come too early', he then said; 'my time is not yet. This tremendous event is still on its way, wandering; it has not yet reached the ears of men. Lightning and thunder need time; the light of the stars needs time; deeds need time, even after they are done, in order to be seen and heard. This deed is still more remote to them than the remotest stars - and yet they have done it themselves!' It is still recounted how on the same day the madman forced his way into several churches and there started singing his requiem aeternam deo (Grant God eternal rest). Led out and called to account, he is said always to have replied nothing but, 'What then are these churches now if not the tombs and sepulchres of God?'

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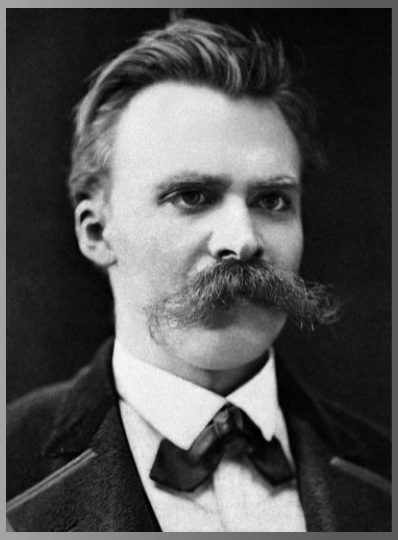

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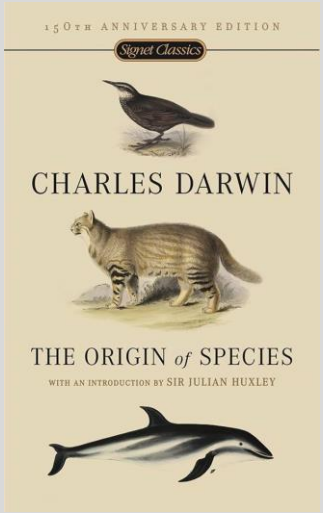
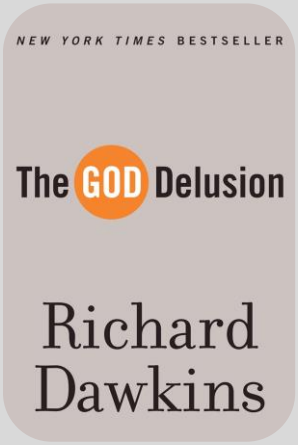


1859

- What does Nietzsche mean that "God is dead"?
- Charles Darwin's *The Origin of Species* was published in 1859
- For the modern philosopher and scientist, the idea of God's "death" was a liberation worthy of celebration
- They mock and deride all religious people in their own sense of superiority

22

The Fool Says in His Heart…



2006

- Nietzsche does not mean that God has literally died for he did not believe in God to begin with
- He is asking these Atheists to what end they have been liberated
- If they replace "the idea of God" with "scientism," what will it lead to?
- "God is dead" essentially means "truth is dead"
- Everything falls into *nihilism*

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Nihilism Defined

- Nihilism – "the belief that all values are baseless and that nothing can be known or communicated"
  - Internet Encyclopedia of Philosophy, https://iep.utm.edu/nihilism/
- Real truth cannot be attained or known
- All morality and reason are skeptical
- If there is any meaning in anything, it is only what meaning attributed by an individual
- Everything essentially becomes relative

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Avoiding Nihilism?

- Some wish to pursue this scientific end while retaining some semblance of God

25

"

I like to live in a culturally Christian country, even if I don't believe a single word of Christian faith.

-Richard Dawkins

"

https://www.premierchristianity.com/opinion/richard-dawkins-wants-to-be-a-cultural-christian-but-theres-no-such-thing/17459.article

26

Avoiding Nihilism?

- This is the goal of the modern liberal church
- They keep the idea of God around while endlessly pursuing progressive ideologies
- They hold to everything that the culture believes (or does not believe?) but retain God in whatever image they create Him (or her?) to be

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Are We There Yet?

- Nietzsche wrote that in 1882, but said that his warning was not for his day
- It is now 2026, has our culture "killed God"?
- We have worked in every way to remove God from everything possible
- "Separation of Church and State" = "Separation of God from Everything in Culture"

28

To Educate or Not, That is the Question?

- No where has this mantra been pushed more than in our schools in every education level
- God is the source of all truth
- We see what the end of Godless knowledge becomes

[Rhetorical Question] – **Can a TRUE education of human beings be separate from God?**

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